

Questions to kickstart peer review

Overall

- Why do you think this is an interesting topic, and what do you think is a positive aspect of the proposal?
- What are two questions you have about their proposal?

Conceptual framework

- What literature are they speaking to? What will their work contribute to that literature?
- What is their proposed answer? What alternative explanations should they consider?

Research Design

- What is their main question, and how will they answer it? What is their research strategy?
- Name some sources they can cite who support this research strategy for answering their type of question, or scholars who use a similar methodology.
- What is the main counter-argument(s) they expect to face? Explain how they will 1) acknowledge, and 2) try to eliminate these alternative explanations in their research?

Data & Methods

- Describe their data in 1 sentence. Include: level of analysis (state, country), cross-sectional or longitudinal (or both), time period covered.
- What is their empirical strategy? Why is it appropriate for answering their question, given the data at hand?
- What are their main hypotheses? How will their analysis be set up to provide evidence for / against?
- Describe their main DV(s) and IV(s) and how they are operationalized.